

Statement of Purpose: Amazon Machine Learning Summer School

I've always hated treating machine learning models like magic black boxes. As a second-year AI & Data Science student at IIITDM Kurnool, my biggest priority has been figuring out how things actually work under the hood. That's what pushed me to build the original Transformer architecture entirely from scratch using pure PyTorch. I wanted to genuinely understand multi-head attention and causal masking, rather than just calling a HuggingFace API and hoping for the best.

That curiosity quickly spilled over into building full-scale projects. Recently, I built *CourtSense-AI*, a computer vision pipeline that takes 2D tennis match videos and turns them into 3D interactive replays. I used YOLOv8-Pose and SegFormer, but the real challenge was optimizing it with TensorRT to hit 30+ FPS on edge hardware. I also wanted to get my hands dirty with multimodal AI, so I built my own version of the PaliGemma vision-language model from the ground up, hooking up a SigLIP encoder to a Gemma-2B decoder and using 8-bit quantization to cut VRAM usage in half.

Right now, I'm working as a Research Intern at SVNIT Surat, focusing on the security side of AI. I recently discovered that if you execute a surgical adversarial attack on just the Stage-4 attention blocks of a SegFormer model, its accuracy absolutely crashes from 97% down to 2% on the Market-1501 dataset. We call it a "Nuclear Attack," and the research paper is currently under review. But I don't just keep these things to myself; as the ML Coordinator for my campus GDG, I recently led a 12-week bootcamp where I taught over 200 students how to go from learning basic gradient descent to shipping real-world ML apps.

Despite everything I've built, there is still a massive gap in my knowledge that I'm hoping the Amazon MLSS can help me fill. I know how to train and deploy complex architectures on local GPUs and edge devices, but I have almost no experience scaling these models to a massive, distributed enterprise level. I want to learn Amazon's actual industry standards for things like distributed training, automating robust MLOps pipelines, and handling incredibly large, noisy datasets in the cloud.

I believe I'd be a great fit for this program because I have a proven track record of diving into the deep end and learning fast. I'm the kind of developer who tears architectures apart to find their bottlenecks rather than just using them blindly. I would absolutely love the opportunity to absorb Amazon's expertise in scalable AI, use it to push my research further, and eventually share those enterprise-grade insights with the students I mentor.